This composition was commissioned by the American Choral Directors Association Endowment in memory of Raymond W. Brock, who served the American Choral Directors Association as Director of Development and Administrative Assistant.

In Time of Silver Rain

SATB (div.) and Piano

Words by Langston Hughes (1901-1967)
Music by Andre J. Thomas (b. 1952)

JG2691
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6
7
8
rain
The earth
puts forth new life
rain
The earth
puts forth
new life
rain
new life
rain
new life
9
10
11
a - gain,
a - gain,
a - gain,
Green
a - gain,
Green
mf
mf

12
13
14
mf
And flow - ers lift their heads, And o - ver all the
mf
And flow - ers lift their heads, And o - ver all the
grass - es grow
grass - es grow
mf
15
16
17
plain
Of
plain
Of
The won - der spreads Of
The won - der spreads Of

18
19
20
f
life, Of life, Of life!
f
life, Of life, Of life!
f
life, Of life, Of life!
f
life, Of life, Of life!
f
21
22
mf

23
24
25
mf
In time of sil - ver rain The
In time of sil - ver rain The
In time of sil - ver rain
In time of sil - ver rain
mp
mf
26
27
28
p
but-ter-flies lift silk - en wings To
but-ter-flies lift silk - en wings To

29
30
31
mf
catch a rain - bow cry, And trees put forth new
catch a rain - bow cry, And trees put forth new
new
new
32
33
34
mp
leaves to sing in joy, joy, in
leaves to sing in joy, joy, in
leaves to sing in joy, joy, in
leaves to sing in joy, joy, in

35
36
37
mp
joy, joy, in joy be-neath the
joy, joy, in joy be-neath the
joy, joy, in joy be-neath the
joy, joy, in joy be-neath the

38
39
40
mf
sky As
sky As
sky As
sky As

41
42
down the road - way
Pass - ing boys and girls
down the road - way
Pass - ing boys and girls
down the road - way
down the road - way
mf
43
mp
44
45
Go sing - ing,
Go sing - ing,
mp
Pass - ing boys and girls Go sing - ing,
mp
Pass - ing boys and girls Go sing - ing,

46
47
p
too,
mf
48
49
In

50
51
52
time of sil - ver rain,
In
time of sil - ver rain,
In
time of sil - ver rain,
In
time of sil - ver rain,
In

53
54
55
56
time of sil - ver rain
When spring and life are
time of sil - ver rain
When spring and life are
time of sil - ver rain
When spring and life are
time of sil - ver rain
When spring and life are

57
58
59
f
new,
spring and life are new,
8vb
60
61
ff
spring and life are new.
8va
8vb

About the Piece

Langston Hughes' poem "In Time of Silver Rain" was featured in the 1947 collection of Fields of Wonder poems. With everything happening in our world today, this poem portrays an optimistic outlook on life. Although there is no consensus on the meaning of "silver rain," here it represents the idea that, as in life, something good can come from both gentle and heavy rain. It also symbolizes winter's end and spring rain's arrival. For all who are navigating the ups and downs of life in every season, take comfort in knowing that spring will come, bringing new beginnings.

André J. Thomas, composer

Other settings by the composer of other Langston Hughes poems include: Hold Fast to Dreams (Hinshaw Music) and I Dream a World (Heritage Music).

In Time of Silver Rain (1947)

In time of silver rain,
the earth puts forth new life again,
green grasses grow,
and flowers lift their heads,
and over, all the plain,
the wonder spreads
Of Life, Of Life, Of life!

In time of silver rain,
the butterflies lift silken wings
to catch a rainbow cry,
and trees put forth
new leaves to sing in joy beneath the sky
as down the roadway passing boys and girls
go singing, too, in time of silver rain
when spring and life are new.

Langston Hughes, poet

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Duration: 2:45

André J. Thomas, Composer

Dr. André J. Thomas served on the faculty of Florida State University from 1984 until his retirement in 2019 as Owen F. Sellers Professor of Music, Director of Choral Activities, and Professor of Choral Music Education. He was appointed Professor of Choral Conducting and Interim conductor of the Yale Camerata for the 2020–2022 academic year. From 1988-2019, he also served as Artistic Director of the Tallahassee Community Chorus. He previously served on the faculty of the University of Texas at Austin. Dr. Thomas received a B.S. degree in Music Education from Friends University, an MM in Piano Performance from Northwestern University, and a DMA in Choral Conducting from the University of Illinois.

Besides his extensive conducting credits, he has distinguished himself as a composer/arranger. His compositions and arrangements are published by Gentry Publications, Heritage Music Press, Hinshaw Music Company, Mark Foster Music Company, FitzSimons Music Company, Lawson–Gould, Earthsongs, Laurel Press, and Choristers Guild.

For more information about Dr. Thomas, please visit: https://www.drandrethomas.com

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